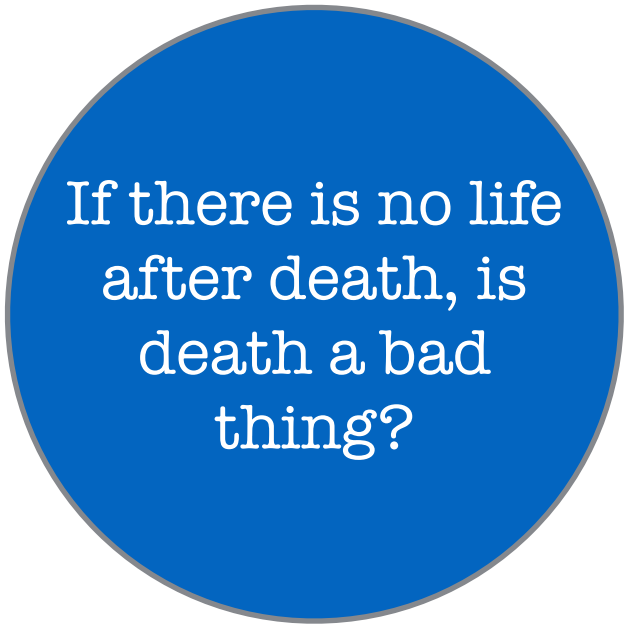
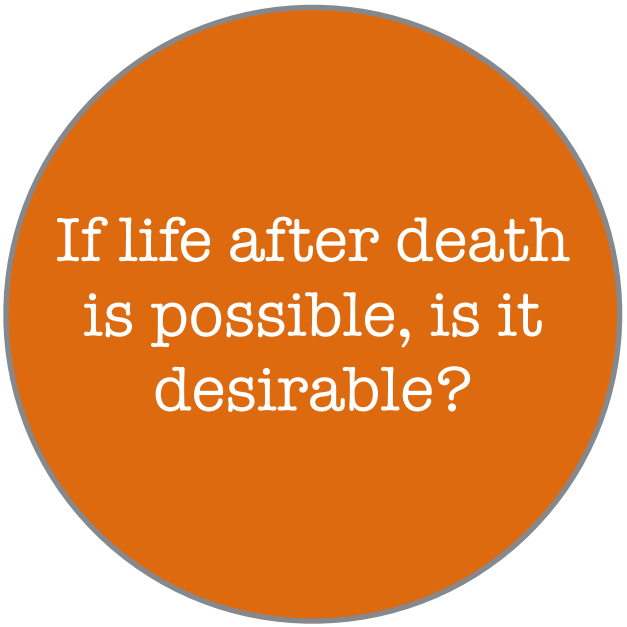




If there is no life
after death, is
death a bad
thing?



Is there life after
death?

A large orange circle with a thin grey border, containing white text.

If life after death
is possible, is it
desirable?

When we were discussing the nature of persons, we discussed the question of whether life after death is possible. Life after death seems pretty clear possible on proponent of soul survival or psychological views; matters are trickier if materialism about persons is true, but even here there is room to believe in the possibility of life after death.

But of course even if life after death is possible, that doesn't tell us whether or not there is life after death. Let's turn to that question now.

There are a number of arguments for and against life after death that I'll mention only briefly and then set aside.

The first is what might be called the **argument from religion**. There are as many versions of this argument as there are religions; here is one

1. Christianity is true.

2. If Christianity is true, there is life after death.

C. There is life after death.

The second argument I am going to mention and then set aside is the

argument from near death experiences.

Many people who come very close to death report similar kinds of experiences — a feeling of looking down at one's body, of feeling disembodied, of moving towards a light. One might argue from these experiences as follows:

1. People have near death experiences.
 2. If there were no life after death, people would not have near death experiences..
-

C. There is life after death.

Instead we will look at the main philosophical argument for life after death.

It is worth noting that this is an argument for life after death, but cannot in any obvious way (unlike the argument from religion) be turned into an argument for immortality.

The first argument has its origins in Plato's *Phaedo*. This is a dialogue which takes place between Socrates and his friends, after Socrates has been sentenced to death for corrupting the youth of Athens.

Socrates is unworried, explaining to his friends that death is nothing to be afraid of; death is just the death of the body, and not the death of him.

He gives a few arguments in favor of this view; the most influential is contained in the following passage.

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